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Eng523 Solved Final Term Past Papers

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Paper No. 1 Spring 2024

Total Question:10

Total Marks:27

Attempt Any 4 Question Short And 3 Questions Long:

Short Questions (3 Marks)

1. **Define sociolinguistics:**

Sociolinguistics is the study of the relationship between language and society. It examines how language use varies and changes in different social contexts and how social factors such as class, gender, ethnicity, and age influence language.

2. **What is interactional sociolinguistics?**

Interactional sociolinguistics focuses on the social aspects of communication. It studies the interaction between individuals and the ways

in which language reflects and influences social relationships, focusing on how conversational dynamics are shaped by social context.

3. According to Potter, define contrived data.

Contrived data refers to data that is created or manipulated for research purposes, often in controlled experimental settings, as opposed to naturally occurring data.

4. Explain the Discourse-Historical Approach (DHA).

The Discourse-Historical Approach (DHA) is an approach in Critical Discourse Analysis that combines historical context with discourse analysis to examine how power, ideology, and historical factors influence the structure and content of discourse.

5. Describe faster and slower speech in an intonation unit.

Faster speech tends to reduce the number of intonation units, with quicker transitions between phrases, while slower speech provides more pronounced pauses and a greater number of intonation units, highlighting clarity and emphasis.

6. Define discursive psychology and list its principles.

Discursive psychology examines how psychological themes, such as emotions or attitudes, are constructed in discourse. Its principles include:

- Focus on language use in real-life contexts.
- Understanding the function of discourse in constructing reality.
- The analysis of how people use language to position themselves and others in conversation.

Long Questions (5 Marks)

1. Explain critical discourse analysis.

Critical discourse analysis (CDA) explores how language reflects, constructs, and perpetuates social and political power dynamics. It examines the ways in which discourse reflects ideologies, power relations, and cultural biases, focusing on how texts influence and are influenced by societal structures.

2. Define and explain an intonation unit.

An intonation unit is a segment of speech that is characterized by a single rising and/or falling pitch pattern. It typically corresponds to a complete thought or idea and can be used to convey meaning, emotion, and focus within spoken discourse.

3. Discuss the difference between reference and substitution.

Reference involves pointing to something directly (e.g., using pronouns like "he," "she," or "it" to refer back to something previously mentioned), whereas substitution involves replacing one element of discourse with another (e.g., using "one" to replace a noun or phrase).

4. Describe the principle of discursive psychology.

Discursive psychology examines how people use language to construct and negotiate psychological phenomena, focusing on how emotions, attitudes, and identities are conveyed through discourse, rather than assuming they are pre-existing internal states.

5. Explain the use of intonation in conveying meaning in discourse.

Intonation plays a crucial role in conveying meaning in spoken discourse by signaling emotions, attitudes, emphasis, and the structure of information. Changes in pitch, rhythm, and tone can alter the interpretation of a sentence, such as distinguishing between a question and a statement.

Paper No. 2 Spring 2024

Total Question:10

Total Marks:27

Attempt Any 4 Question Short And 3 Questions Long:

Short Questions (3 Marks)

1. What is linguistic anthropology?

Linguistic anthropology is the study of how language shapes and is shaped by social and cultural contexts. It examines the relationship between

language and culture, including how language reflects social identities and power dynamics.

2. Which factors are used in the representation of a corpus?

Factors in representing a corpus include the type of data (spoken or written), genre, context, size of the corpus, demographic factors (such as age, gender, and social class), and the linguistic features being analyzed (e.g., syntax, lexis, discourse markers).

3. Define transitivity in linguistics.

Transitivity refers to the grammatical property of a verb that determines whether it requires a direct object to complete its meaning. In transitive verbs, an object is needed, while in intransitive verbs, no object is necessary.

4. What is the difference between reference and ellipsis-substitution?

Reference involves pointing to something specific within discourse (e.g., using pronouns or definite articles), while ellipsis-substitution involves omitting parts of a sentence that are understood from context, or substituting one element for another.

5. Define text and its significance in linguistics.

A text is a unit of language used in communication that is structured to convey meaning. In linguistics, a text is significant because it is the primary object of analysis for studying how language functions within various contexts, reflecting social and cultural norms.

6. What are the kinds of discourse analysis projects?

The kinds of discourse analysis projects include:

- Interactional analysis (examining conversations and social interactions).
- Critical discourse analysis (focusing on power, ideology, and social relations).
- Corpus-based discourse analysis (using large corpora of texts to study linguistic patterns).

- Multimodal discourse analysis (analyzing texts that use multiple modes of communication, such as images and sounds).

Long Questions (5 Marks)

1. What is discourse analysis?

Discourse analysis is the study of language use in context, examining how texts and spoken interactions are structured to convey meaning. It looks at how language functions in social contexts, exploring how social, cultural, and power dynamics influence communication.

2. Write a few considerations that need to be taken into account while deciding a topic.

Considerations include:

- Relevance to the target audience.
- Clarity of the research question.
- Availability of data and resources.
- Theoretical framework and methodology.
- Ethical considerations in data collection and analysis.

3. Explain subject-verb agreement and the rule for relative clauses.

Subject-verb agreement refers to the rule that the subject and verb in a sentence must agree in number (singular/plural). In relative clauses, the relative pronoun (who, which, that) agrees with the noun it refers to in terms of number and gender.

4. What are the factors that help in examining social and cultural genres?

Factors include:

- Social context and the purpose of communication.
- Cultural norms and values.
- Audience expectations and roles.
- Discourse structures and conventions within the genre.

5. Discuss the importance of text analysis in discourse studies.

Text analysis is essential in discourse studies as it provides insight into how language structures reflect and shape social realities, ideologies, and power dynamics. It helps identify underlying patterns and meanings in both spoken and written discourse.

Paper No. 3 Spring 2024

Total Question:10

Total Marks:27

Attempt Any 4 Question Short And 3 Questions Long:

Short Questions (3 Marks)

1. List the terms associated with media discourse.

Terms include: framing, agenda-setting, bias, representation, intertextuality, and ideology.

2. Explain the concept of idiomatic phrases in discourse.

Idiomatic phrases are expressions whose meanings cannot be inferred directly from the individual words. They are used to convey cultural nuances and are essential in making discourse sound natural.

3. Define corpus in linguistics.

A corpus in linguistics is a large, structured set of texts or spoken language data used for linguistic analysis, allowing researchers to study language patterns and trends.

4. Differentiate between fast and slow speakers with the help of intonation.

Fast speakers tend to have a higher speech rate and use fewer pauses between intonation units, while slow speakers typically have a more deliberate pace, with clearer intonation boundaries, and use more pauses.

5. Define media discourse.

Media discourse refers to the language and communication used in media

texts, including print, broadcast, and online forms, analyzing how these texts shape public opinion, ideologies, and social norms.

6. According to Bloor and Bloor, note the usage of substitution and ellipsis.

Bloor and Bloor highlight that substitution replaces a word or phrase in discourse with a different term, while ellipsis omits parts of the sentence when they are understood from the context.

Long Questions (5 Marks)

1. Describe the main concept of the discourse analysis paradigm.

The discourse analysis paradigm focuses on the idea that language is not just a medium of communication but is also a tool for constructing social reality. It examines how language shapes identities, ideologies, and power structures within society.

2. Discuss the relationship between beats and rhythm in discourse.

Beats are short pauses in speech that help organize discourse, while rhythm refers to the overall pattern of speech flow. Together, beats and rhythm contribute to the naturalness, emphasis, and pacing of discourse.

3. What is the main concept of the Discourse-Historical Approach (DHA)?

DHA emphasizes understanding discourse in its historical and social context. It examines how historical events, cultural ideologies, and power relations shape the discourse in texts, especially in relation to ideology and social change.

4. Describe the role of EAP in language learning.

English for Academic Purposes (EAP) supports students in acquiring the specific language skills necessary for academic contexts, including reading, writing, listening, and speaking, focusing on language used in academic texts and communication.

5. Describe the difference between reference and ellipsis in discourse.

Reference involves mentioning or alluding to something in the discourse, while ellipsis omits parts of the sentence or discourse, leaving out words or phrases that can be inferred from context.

Paper No. 4 Spring 2024

Total Question:10

Total Marks:27

Attempt Any 4 Question Short And 3 Questions Long:

Short Questions (3 Marks)

1. Explain discourse analysis with reference to Fairclough's framework.

Fairclough's framework for discourse analysis involves analyzing texts at three levels: text (linguistic features), discursive practice (production and interpretation), and social practice (context and power relations).

2. Name three fundamental observations of discourse psychology.

- Discursive psychology studies how psychological phenomena are constructed in discourse.
- It examines how language is used to position people and construct identities.
- It focuses on the functional role of discourse in shaping attitudes and beliefs.

3. What is English for Academic Purposes (EAP)?

EAP is an approach to language learning that focuses on developing the skills necessary for academic study, particularly in reading, writing, and presenting in academic settings.

4. According to Winter, how can the relationship between clauses be signaled?

Winter suggests that relationships between clauses can be signaled through coordinating and subordinating conjunctions, as well as through intonation and punctuation.

5. Name three approaches to the study of media discourse.

- Critical discourse analysis.
- Semiotic analysis.

- Intertextual analysis.

6. According to Michael, how many types of social meaning are drawn in the use of language?

Michael identifies three types of social meaning: ideational (what the text is about), interpersonal (relations between participants), and textual (how the message is structured).

Long Questions (5 Marks)

1. List the factors that impact the opportunities for collaboration in discourse analysis.

- Research interests and goals.
- Expertise and methodological approaches.
- Theoretical frameworks.
- Availability of data and resources.
- Institutional or disciplinary norms.

2. Explain the relationship between discourse and social practices.

Discourse shapes and is shaped by social practices. Language reflects societal norms, values, and ideologies, while at the same time, it helps to establish and reinforce social structures and power dynamics.

3. Discuss the impact of faster and slower speech on intonation units.

Faster speech tends to reduce pauses and intonation units, leading to more rapid transitions, whereas slower speech often emphasizes clarity, with longer pauses and more pronounced intonation units.

4. Describe the role of media discourse in shaping public opinion.

Media discourse plays a crucial role in shaping public opinion by influencing how issues are framed and represented, thus impacting societal perceptions and beliefs through selective reporting and language use.

5. Explain the significance of interactional sociolinguistics in understanding discourse.

Interactional sociolinguistics emphasizes the social aspects of

communication, focusing on how language use varies according to social context and how conversational patterns reflect and construct social relationships.

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